İlkşen Çetintaş

CHIEF HUMAN RESOURCES OFFICER · EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE MEMBER

Organizational transformation · Reward & job architecture · Board partner on workforce cost, productivity and people risk

Ankara, Türkiye · linkedin.com/in/ilkşen-çetintaş-b52a6920 · Dual Turkish & EU citizen · open to international relocation

~5,000 employees in Group HR remit at IC Holding	**4% → 25%** women in tech roles in 1 year · EBRD Gold
~2,000 employees · 11 factories · CHRO & ExCom since 2021	**BIST 2026** ŞA-RA listed on Borsa İstanbul, July 2026

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

CHRO and Executive Committee member with 25+ years in industrial, defense and global technology groups, turning founder-led businesses into institutions. At **ŞA-RA Group** (~2,000 employees, 11 factories; listed on Borsa İstanbul in 2026) built HR governance, group-wide grading and pay, and a productivity unit that links labor cost to production tonnage for Board capacity decisions. Previously Deputy GM HR of **IC Holding** (~5,000 employees), leading the gender initiative behind an EBRD Gold Award, then CHRO of defense company **Nurol Teknoloji**. Trained at **Siemens** and **Turkish Aerospace (TAI)**. Targeting CHRO, Chief People Officer and Group HR Director roles in Türkiye and internationally.

SIGNATURE ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Award-winning gender inclusion:** led the initiative that raised women in technical roles from 4% to 25% within one year at TREDAŞ, IC Holding's electricity distributor; the program won the EBRD Gold Award for Environmental & Social Best Practice (2019).
- **Institutionalized a ~2,000-employee, 11-factory group** (listed on Borsa İstanbul in July 2026): built ŞA-RA's HR operating model, governance, grading and pay structure and people systems from the ground up.
- **Productivity managed like a P&L line:** founded a Workforce Productivity & Planning Unit that ties planned vs. actual production tonnage to unit labor cost and workforce mix, giving the Board a fact base for capacity decisions.
- **One pay logic for ~5,000 employees:** Hay-based job evaluation across every IC Holding company, with a common grading framework and salary scales to support consistent pay decisions and internal equity across construction, energy, airports and tourism.
- **HR as a business at Siemens Communications Türkiye:** built the HR function, played a key role in turning it into a profit center through internal service agreements and pricing, and led the Siemens Leadership Excellence program that became a benchmark across Siemens Europe.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ŞA-RA Group (ŞA-RA Enerji İnşaat Tic. ve San. A.Ş.) · Ankara — 2021 – Present

Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO) · Executive Committee Member

Energy-infrastructure manufacturer and contractor founded in 1985: steel structures, transmission hardware and galvanizing; 11 factories, projects in 120+ countries; ~2,000 employees. Listed on Borsa İstanbul in July 2026.

- **Transformation:** lead institutionalization and culture change, building HR policies, structures and people systems from the ground up and repositioning HR from approvals to a strategic function accountable for governance, productivity and organizational effectiveness.
- **Talent systems:** group-wide workforce planning, recruitment, succession, career planning and leadership development across factories and central functions.
- **Board partnership:** strategic partner to the Board and Executive Committee, preparing the productivity, workforce-cost and people-risk analyses behind workforce and capacity decisions.
- **Workforce productivity:** founded and lead the Workforce Productivity & Planning Unit; designed a planning framework linking planned vs. actual production tonnage, unit labor cost and workforce composition across heavy industrial operations.

- **Reward architecture:** built a grade- and band-based salary structure (minimum, midpoint, maximum per grade) across all Group companies, positioned every role against it and proposed salary adjustments to improve internal pay equity (compensation & benefits).
- **Pay for performance:** designed scorecard-based management by objectives (departmental goal pools, shared cross-functional goals, weighted individual scorecards with evidence requirements) and a variable-pay framework combining scorecard, competency and talent-matrix results, to support consistent, performance-based bonus decisions.
- **HR digitalization:** designed and implemented an e-HR platform inside the company ERP, putting objectives, competency assessments and approval workflows on one system.
- **Governance & cost:** brought labor-law compliance and people risk under one HR governance framework; prepare the annual HR budget (salaries, bonuses, statutory contributions, severance, benefits, training, consultancy).

Nurol Teknoloji A.Ş. · Ankara 2019 – 2021

Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO)

Defense-technology company of Nurol Holding: advanced ballistic ceramics and armor systems for personnel, vehicles and aircraft.

- **Succession for critical roles:** led HR strategy in defense technology and built performance, talent-development and reward systems that strengthened the leadership pipeline and succession readiness for critical technical roles; introduced competency-based learning frameworks to improve role readiness.
- **Regulated operations:** managed large blue-collar workforces and regulatory compliance in a highly controlled defense environment.
- **Early-career & diversity:** launched diversity-focused internships and university–industry programs, expanding the early-career talent pipeline and improving workforce diversity indicators.
- **HR technology:** played a direct role in SAP integration and the implementation of SAP SuccessFactors.

IC Holding (IC İbrahim Çeçen Yatırım Holding) · Ankara 2013 – 2019

Deputy General Manager, Human Resources

Diversified Turkish conglomerate: construction & infrastructure (incl. the Yavuz Sultan Selim Bridge and Northern Marmara Motorway), energy generation and distribution (TREDAŞ), airports, tourism and industry; ~5,000 employees in HR remit.

- **Gender inclusion:** led the TREDAŞ initiative that lifted women in technical roles from 4% to 25% in one year (EBRD Gold Award 2019).
- **Job architecture:** ran Hay-based job evaluation across all holding companies (know-how, problem solving, decision authority, management scope and financial impact) and set job grades and salary scales on one common framework, enabling consistent pay decisions and internal equity Group-wide.
- **Workforce cost:** directed HR strategy and workforce-cost planning; prepared HR budgets for salaries, variable pay, statutory contributions, termination costs, benefits, training and consultancy.
- **Pay for performance:** designed corporate competency management and variable-compensation scorecards linking performance outcomes directly to reward.
- **HR digitalization:** led SAP-based HR process implementation and workforce analytics, improving data transparency and management decision-making.

TED University · Ankara 2011 – 2013

HR Director

Foundation university established by the Turkish Education Association (TED); joined during its establishment, ahead of the 2012 academic launch.

- Built the university's HR function and people-governance framework from inception, as part of the establishment team.

Swissôtel Ankara · Ankara 2009 – 2011

HR Director · Executive Committee Member

Five-star luxury hotel of the Swissôtel Hotels & Resorts brand.

- Led talent development and change initiatives within global hospitality operations as a member of the hotel's Executive Committee.

Siemens Communications, Türkiye

1996 – 2006

Group Human Resources Manager

Siemens Industries Inc.: Siemens' telecommunications business in Türkiye, covering carrier infrastructure, enterprise networks and mobile devices.

- **HR as a business:** established and led the HR department; played a key role in transforming it from a service unit into a profit center through internal service agreements and pricing, strengthening cost transparency and accountability.
- **Leadership:** led the Siemens Leadership Excellence program in Türkiye, which became a benchmark across Siemens Europe.
- **Reward:** led company-wide job evaluation (CRG, Hay), built grade- and band-based pay structures and tied corporate scorecards to variable pay.
- **Talent systems:** set up assessment and development centers, onboarding and outplacement programs; coordinated the rollout of the global recruitment portal across Turkish operations; contributed directly to SAP HR integration.

Turkish Aerospace Industries (TAI) · Ankara

1988 – 1996

Senior HR Lead

Türkiye's national aerospace company, founded in 1984 for F-16 co-production.

- Contributed to HR policy for job evaluation, salary scales, wage policy, salary surveys, performance management and reward; delivered appraisal and development workshops (HR management, business ethics) for first-line and middle managers.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

2025 **Exemplary Woman HR Marvel of the Year**, Global Business Conclave, London (White Page International).

2024 **Global 200 Power Leaders**, selected among senior executives from 42 countries, Dubai (White Page International).

2019 **EBRD Gold Award, Environmental & Social Best Practice**, won by TREDAŞ / IC İçtaş Elektrik for its gender-inclusion program; led the initiative and was instrumental in securing the award.

2018 **Ministry of Energy and Natural Resources Award**: selected among the top three most successful businesswomen in mining and energy.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- People & HR Strategy
- Business & Culture Transformation
- HR Governance & People Risk
- Job Evaluation (Hay, CRG)
- Performance & Variable Pay
- Succession & Career Planning
- Culture & Employee Engagement
- HR Digital Transformation & HRIS
- Employment Law Compliance
- HR Operating Model Design
- Change Management
- Compensation & Benefits
- Grading & Salary Structures
- Strategic Workforce Planning
- Talent Management
- Diversity, Equity & Inclusion
- SAP & SAP SuccessFactors
- Multi-site & Blue-collar Workforces
- Organizational Effectiveness
- Board & Stakeholder Management
- Reward Strategy & Total Rewards
- Internal Pay Equity
- Workforce Cost & Productivity
- Leadership Development
- Talent Acquisition & Early Careers
- People Analytics
- Assessment & Development Centers

EDUCATION

Middle East Technical University (METU), Bachelor's Degree in Management — Ankara

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages	Turkish (native) · English (advanced) · German (good working proficiency)
Mobility	Dual Turkish & EU citizen; open to relocation within Türkiye and internationally

REFERENCES

Senior references (TED, Siemens) available on request.